KEY TOPIC 1 COURSE TEXTBOOK • CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1558–1569

QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558–1569

From Accession Crisis and the 1559 Religious Settlement to the Arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots



ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD • 15 JANUARY 1559 NPG-LONDON / ACC-1559-CORONATION

The Coronation Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I, Westminster Abbey

Elizabeth I enthroned in cloth of gold robes patterned with Tudor roses and French fleurs-de-lis, bearing the royal orb and sceptre, symbolising sovereign majesty and the restoration of royal independence.

ARCHIVAL PRIMARY RECORD — EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT — KEY TOPIC 1 COVERAGE MATRIX

1.1 ACCESSION (1558)

- Social hierarchy & **Great Chain of Being**; Court, Privy Council & Parliament.
- Legitimacy doubts, 16th-century gender prejudice & the **marriage dilemma**.
- Crown debt of **£300,000**, debasement & Antwerp moneylenders.
- Foreign threats: loss of Calais, Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis & **Auld Alliance**.
- Fiscal reform: William Cecil, Crown land sales & cutting royal expenditures.

1.1 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

Nov 1558: Accession of Elizabeth I
↓
Nov 1558: Cecil Appointed Principal Secretary
↓
Jan 1559: Coronation in Westminster Abbey
↓
Apr 1559: Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis (Calais lost)

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Royal Prerogative vs Crown Debt • *Exam Link: Q1 Feature / Q2 Causation*

1.2 SETTLEMENT (1559)

- Religious divisions: Catholic North/West vs Protestant South-East.
- **Act of Supremacy**: Elizabeth adopts title of **Supreme Governor**.
- **Act of Uniformity**: 1559 Prayer Book, ambiguous communion & 1s recusancy fine.
- **Royal Injunctions**, nationwide visitations & clerical licensing.
- Church courts as instruments of social control, morality & community cohesion.

1.2 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

Feb 1559: Commons Debates Religious Bills
↓
Apr 1559: Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity
↓
Summer 1559: Royal Injunctions Issued
↓
1559–60: Nationwide Episcopal Visitations

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Legislative Via Media Compromise • *Exam Link: Q1 Feature / Q3 Essay*

1.3 CHALLENGES

- Puritan challenge: **Crucifix Controversy** & 1566 **Vestment Controversy**.
- Catholic challenge: northern nobility recusancy & 1566 Papal decree.
- European Counter-Reformation: Council of Trent & **Douai seminary (1568)**.
- Spanish threat in Netherlands: Duke of Alba's 50,000 veteran troops.
- **Papal Bull (1570)**: *Regnans in Excelsis* excommunication & 1571 Treasons Act.

1.3 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

1566: The Dutch Revolt Begins
↓
Mar 1566: Parker's Book of Advertisements
↓
1567: Alba's Army Deployed to Netherlands
↓
1568: Douai Seminary College Founded

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Puritan Vestments & Counter-Reformation • *Exam Link: Q2 Causation / Q3 Essay*

1.4 MARY STUART (1568–69)

- Dynastic claim: Catholic claimant, Scottish scandal & Darnley's murder.
- Escape from Lochleven & arrival at **Workington, Cumberland (May 1568)**.
- Elizabeth's constitutional dilemma: the four fatal options regarding Mary.
- **Conference of York (1568–69)**: Casket Letters & "not proven" verdict.
- Indefinite English captivity & catalyst for the **1569 Northern Revolt**.

1.4 CHRONOLOGICAL CAUSAL FLOW

Feb 1567: Darnley Murdered at Kirk o' Field
↓
16 May 1568: Mary Stuart Lands at Workington
↓
Oct 1568: Conference of York Inquiries Open
↓
Nov 1569: Revolt of the Northern Earls

CORE DISCIPLINARY FOCUS
Dynastic Legitimacy & Northern Revolt • *Exam Link: Q2 Causation / Q3 Essay*

ENQUIRY 1 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 1.1

The Situation on Elizabeth's Accession, 1558

Historical Enquiry: From crippling debt to looming foreign invasion: How did an inexperienced queen secure a divided and vulnerable England in 1558?

SECTION 1 SETTING THE SCENE: THE FRAGILE TUDOR PYRAMID & GOVERNANCE

[1.1] In the bitter freeze of November 1558, twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth Tudor ascended the throne of an exhausted, anxious nation of three million people after surviving five perilous years under Mary I. Tudor society was strictly organized by the **Great Chain of Being**—an immutable cosmic hierarchy ordained by God where every soul held an assigned station and owed unquestioned obedience to their superiors. In the countryside, roughly fifty noble families and landed gentry owned the earth, ruling over yeomen, tenant husbandmen, and landless labourers. In towns, wealthy merchants formed an urban elite above skilled guildsmen and destitute apprentices. Social mobility was deeply distrusted, and any attempt to disrupt this divinely appointed social order was viewed as sinful treason against God and Crown.

[1.2] Government centred upon the personal sovereignty of the monarch, who claimed to rule by **Divine Right**. Yet the Crown commanded neither a standing army nor a salaried police force. Power was exercised through an intricate web of **royal patronage**. By dispensing titles, land grants, knighthoods, and commercial monopolies, Elizabeth bound ambitious aristocrats to Crown service. Executive administration was conducted by the **Privy Council**—a tight circle of roughly nineteen trusted noblemen meeting multiple times weekly to direct national defense, taxation, and diplomacy. At its helm stood **Sir William Cecil**, appointed Principal Secretary on accession day.

[1.3] Statutory legislation and extraordinary taxation required the consent of **Parliament**, divided between the House of Lords and House of Commons. As an occasional instrument summoned only when the monarch required emergency **subsidies** (taxes), Parliament gathered just nine times during Elizabeth's forty-five-year reign. In the shires, royal commands were executed by **Lord Lieutenants**, great nobles responsible for county militias, and unpaid **Justices of the Peace (JPs)**. These country gentry enforced statutory law, repaired highways, collected rates, and punished petty crime, linking Whitehall directives to rural reality.

PRIMARY RECORD OFFICIAL SOVEREIGN ADDRESS 20 November 1558

Source A: Queen Elizabeth's Hatfield Speech to her Council

> *"The law of nature moveth me to sorrow for my sister; the burden that is fallen upon me maketh me amazed... I mean to direct all my actions by good advice and counsel. And therefore I shall require of you all nothing more but to be faithful assistants unto me, that I with my ruling and you with your service may make a good account to almighty God and leave some comfort to our posterity on earth."*

Delivered by the twenty-five-year-old Elizabeth at Hatfield House immediately following Mary I's death, signaling her intention to govern through broad conciliar consensus rather than autocracy.

Hinge Question: *How did Elizabeth's pledge to take "good advice and counsel" help reassure both conservative Catholic and reforming Protestant peers after the instability of Mary I's reign?*

SECTION 2 THE VIRGIN QUEEN: LEGITIMACY DOUBTS, MISOGYNY & THE MARRIAGE DILEMMA

[2.1] Elizabeth's accession was immediately stalked by doubts regarding her **legitimacy**. In the eyes of Catholic Europe, Henry VIII's 1533 marriage to Elizabeth's mother, Anne Boleyn, followed an unlawful unilateral divorce from Catherine of Aragon without papal annulment. Catholics regarded Henry's first marriage as indissoluble, meaning Elizabeth was born of an adulterous union. Following Anne Boleyn's 1536 execution, Parliament passed the Second Succession Act declaring Elizabeth illegitimate. Though Henry reinstated her in his 1544 will, Catholics insisted parliamentary statute could never overturn divine canon law, asserting that her Catholic cousin, Mary Stuart, was the true lawful queen.

[2.2] This dynastic vulnerability was intensified by deep sixteenth-century prejudice against female sovereigns. Renaissance Europe taught that women were intellectually and emotionally unsuited for rule, ordained to remain under male authority. A **'Queen Regnant'**—a female ruler exercising absolute command—was viewed as unnatural. Scottish Calvinist John Knox published *The First Blast of the Trumpet Against the Monstrous Regiment of Women*, while Mary I's disastrous reign seemed to validate these fears.

[2.3] Consequently, the Privy Council and Parliament placed intense pressure upon Elizabeth to marry immediately and secure the Tudor Protestant line. Yet marriage was a lethal constitutional trap. Marrying a foreign prince, such as Philip II or Archduke Charles of Austria, risked transforming England into an exploited Catholic satellite. Marrying an English nobleman—such as her favourite, Lord Robert Dudley—would trigger murderous jealousy among rival aristocratic factions, compounded in 1560 by the suspicious death of Dudley's wife, Amy Robsart. With supreme political cunning, Elizabeth declared she was *"married to the realm of England"*, weaponizing courtship diplomacy for over two decades while fiercely guarding her sovereign independence.

PRIMARY RECORD CONFIDENTIAL DIPLOMATIC REPORT December 1558

Source B: Spanish Ambassador's Diplomatic Dispatch

> *"The new Queen is a very vain and clever woman. She must have been thoroughly schooled in the manner in which her father conducted his government... She is determined to be governed by no one. She is very much attached to the common people and is confident that they are all on her side, which is indeed true. The realm is in great debt and defenceless, yet she carries herself with sovereign pride."*

Confidential dispatch from the Count of Feria to King Philip II of Spain, astutely assessing Elizabeth's intellect, popular support, and determination to maintain English sovereign independence.

Hinge Question: *Why did foreign ambassadors view Elizabeth's immense popularity among ordinary Englishmen as her greatest shield against aristocratic factionalism?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 1.1 GLOSSARY

GREAT CHAIN OF BEING
The rigid sixteenth-century social hierarchy established by God, dictating that every person held a fixed, unquestioned rank from monarch down to landless labourer.

ROYAL PATRONAGE
The grant of titles, offices, lands, and trading monopolies by the monarch to secure political loyalty, manage court factions, and maintain nationwide obedience.

PRIVY COUNCIL
A select body of approximately 19 trusted aristocratic advisers who met multiple times weekly to supervise day-to-day administration, finance, and foreign policy.

ROYAL PREROGATIVE
Exclusive sovereign powers belonging solely to the Crown, including the right to decide foreign policy, declare war, and forbid parliamentary debate on religion or succession.

KT 1.1 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

The Situation on Elizabeth's Accession, 1558 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE EXCHEQUER IN RUIN: DEBT, DEBASEMENT & FISCAL AUSTERITY

[3.1] Beyond political intrigue, Elizabeth inherited a royal exchequer on the verge of bankruptcy. Decades of French wars waged by Henry VIII and Mary I had bled the realm dry. In November 1558, Crown debt stood at an astronomical **£300,000**–a crippling liability when ordinary annual revenue was barely £286,667. Crucially, over £100,000 was owed to merchant bankers on the **Antwerp Exchange**, who demanded extortionate interest rates of 14 per cent, leaving England vulnerable to financial blackmail.

[3.2] Traditional royal revenues were severely depleted. Past Tudor monarchs had sold off vast monastic lands, permanently slashing Crown rental yields. To bridge deficits, governments had repeatedly resorted to **debasement**–melting down silver shillings and reminting them with cheap copper. This reckless practice shattered merchant confidence, sparked runaway inflation, and caused real wages to collapse, while the vital cloth trade to Antwerp fell into catastrophic depression.

[3.3] Under William Cecil's direction, Elizabeth instituted ruthless financial austerity. She slashed household expenditure, sold non-essential Crown lands for £120,000, collected feudal dues, and overhauled customs collections. She also recalled debased coins, restoring the silver standard. By 1574, through relentless fiscal discipline, Elizabeth achieved the impossible: she eliminated all Crown debt and accumulated a £300,000 reserve in the Tower of London. This fiscal solvency freed the Crown from dependence on parliamentary subsidies for ordinary governance, greatly strengthening Elizabeth's executive autonomy.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1520–1598



Sir William Cecil

PRINCIPAL SECRETARY OF STATE & QUEEN'S CHIEF MINISTER (LATER 1ST BARON BURGHLEY)

Elizabeth's most trusted political confidant, serving as Secretary of State from 1558 to 1572 and Lord High Treasurer from 1572 until his death. He masterminded the 1559 Religious Settlement, stabilized Crown finances, and coordinated state intelligence.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Appointed Principal Secretary on Elizabeth's accession day in November 1558, drafting her initial proclamations and governing directives.
- Steered the contentious Acts of Supremacy and Uniformity through a resistant House of Lords in the spring Parliament of 1559.
- Consistently urged Elizabeth to execute Mary, Queen of Scots, prioritize fiscal prudence, and construct a Protestant alliance against Catholic Spain.

SECTION 4 FOREIGN GEOPOLITICAL ENCIRCLEMENT: FRANCE, CALAIS & THE AULD ALLIANCE

[4.1] Beyond England's shores, Elizabeth looked out upon a continent dominated by Catholic superpowers. England was formally at war with France, dragged in by Mary I as Spain's ally. In January 1558, French troops commanded by the Duke of Guise captured **Calais**, England's last continental possession held since 1347. The loss shattered English pride: Calais was an essential commercial gateway for wool exports and a naval fortress guarding the Channel, and its loss left England without a military foothold on the European mainland. Mary I famously lamented that 'Calais' would be found engraved upon her heart.

[4.2] In April 1559, Elizabeth signed the **Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis**, formally ending the Franco-Spanish war. France retained Calais for eight years or would pay 500,000 crowns–a diplomatic fiction masking permanent loss. Crucially, the treaty brought peace between France and Spain. For the first time in sixty years, the Catholic superpowers were not fighting each other, creating the terrifying prospect of a united papal crusade against Protestant England. English strategic planning was thus forced to pivot from continental warfare to maritime coastal defense, knowing England stood isolated and vulnerable.

[4.3] This danger was magnified on England's northern border by the historic **Auld Alliance** between France and Scotland. Scotland was ruled by Catholic regent Mary of Guise, commanding French garrisons. Her daughter, **Mary, Queen of Scots**, married the French Dauphin (Francis II in 1559) and openly quartered the English arms on her heraldic banners. England was caught in a lethal pincer between French forces in Paris and Edinburgh. With French garrisons entrenched at Leith, Cecil warned Elizabeth that French troops could march across the Tweed into Northumberland within forty-eight hours.

CORE STRATEGIC MECHANISM POLITICAL PRAGMATISM • 1558

The Marriage Dilemma: Pros vs. Cons of the Royal Match

In sixteenth-century Europe, marriage was the primary instrument for securing dynastic succession and cementing foreign alliances. Yet for Elizabeth, marriage posed an existential constitutional trap:

- **Foreign Prince (e.g. Philip II of Spain, Prince Eric of Sweden):** Would provide military protection and diplomatic weight, but risked dragging England into costly foreign wars and subordinating national interests to a foreign crown (as occurred under Mary I).
- **English Nobleman (e.g. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester):** Would avert foreign domination, but would inevitably trigger ferocious factional jealousy and aristocratic civil war among rival court families like the Howards and Cecils.
- **The Celibate 'Virgin Queen':** Preserved sovereign independence and absolute political control, but left England without a direct Protestant heir, inviting dynastic plots and foreign invasion.

Strategic Legacy: Elizabeth exploited marriage negotiations as diplomatic bait for twenty-five years, stringing along foreign suitors to buy peace while permanently maintaining her sovereign independence.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 1.1 SEQUENCE

17 Nov 1558 • Accession of Elizabeth I
Mary I dies; 25-yr-old Elizabeth succeeds at Hatfield; appoints William Cecil Principal Secretary.

Nov 1558 • Sovereign Debt Crisis
Exchequer inherits £300,000 debt; £100,000 owed to Antwerp financiers at crushing 14% interest.

15 Jan 1559 • Westminster Coronation
Coronation ceremony balances Latin Catholic ritual with English Gospel reading.

Apr 1559 • Peace of Cateau-Cambrésis
Treaty ends Franco-Spanish war; Calais lost, leaving Protestant England defenceless and isolated.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

Exam Challenge: Explain why Elizabeth's legitimacy was questioned when she became queen in 1558. [12 marks]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Her parents' marriage • (2) Mary, Queen of Scots • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 2 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 1.2

The 'Settlement' of Religion, 1559

Historical Enquiry: How successfully did Elizabeth's 1559 'Middle Way' reconcile intense religious divisions while establishing crown authority across England?

SECTION 1 A FRACTURED REALM: RELIGIOUS DIVISIONS & THE SEARCH FOR STABILITY

[1.1] In 1558, England stood on the brink of sectarian catastrophe. Over twenty-five violent years, the English people had suffered whiplash religious upheavals: Henry VIII's rupture with Rome in 1534, Edward VI's iconoclastic Calvinism (1547–1553), and Mary I's bloody Counter-Reformation (1553–1558), during which 284 Protestant men and women were burned alive at the stake for heresy. The realm was geographically and spiritually fractured. The North, the West Midlands, Lancashire, and Wales remained fiercely devoted to traditional Roman Catholicism, Latin masses, and the veneration of saints. Conversely, London, East Anglia, and the South-East contained vibrant, educated Protestant populations committed to continental Reformed theology.

[1.2] Compounding this volatility was the return of hundreds of **Marian exiles**—committed English Protestants who had fled Mary's burnings to live in Calvinist Geneva, Zurich, and Strasbourg. Returning home in November 1558, these zealous reformers expected Elizabeth to sweep away every trace of popery, abolish the hierarchy of bishops, and establish a pure Presbyterian church modelled on John Calvin's Geneva. Elizabeth herself was an educated Protestant, fluent in Greek and Latin, who revered the English Bible. However, unlike the returning exiles, she was a supreme political pragmatist: she understood that forcing radical Protestantism upon a conservative Catholic majority would provoke an immediate peasant rebellion and invite a foreign Catholic crusade.

[1.3] Elizabeth's overarching objective was political survival and civic peace. She sought to forge a **'Middle Way' (*Via Media*)**—a comprehensive church settlement that was firmly Protestant in its official doctrine and governance, but retained traditional Catholic ceremonial beauty, vestments, and episcopal hierarchy. By making church membership inclusive and refusing to police private conscience, Elizabeth sought to secure the outward obedience of conservative Catholics while anchoring England firmly within the Protestant world.

SECTION 2 THE LEGAL PILLARS: ACT OF SUPREMACY & ACT OF UNIFORMITY

[2.1] In the spring Parliament of 1559, Elizabeth and William Cecil steered two landmark statutes through ferocious Catholic opposition in the House of Lords. The first was the **Act of Supremacy (1559)**, which formally severed England's ties to the Papacy and restored Crown control over the Church. In a stroke of political genius, Elizabeth rejected Henry VIII's controversial title of 'Supreme Head'. Instead, she assumed the title of **'Supreme Governor'** of the Church of England. This calculated compromise reassured moderate Catholics, who believed only Christ or the Pope could be head of the Church, while appeasing radical Protestants who argued that scripture forbade a woman from claiming spiritual headship.

[2.2] The Act of Supremacy established an **Oath of Supremacy** mandatory for all public officials, judges, MPs, and clergymen, requiring them to swear fealty to the Queen as Supreme Governor. Any official refusing the oath was stripped of their office and livelihood. Crucially, while all but one of Mary's Catholic bishops refused the oath and were replaced with moderate Protestants, the vast majority of parish priests—roughly 9,000 across England—took the oath and kept their livings, guaranteeing administrative continuity across the countryside.

[2.3] The second pillar was the **Act of Uniformity (1559)**, which established a single, mandatory form of national worship. It enforced the universal use of an updated 1559 **Book of Common Prayer**, written in English. To reconcile conservative Catholics, the communion liturgy was crafted with deliberate, masterly ambiguity: the prayer book merged Cranmer's 1552 Protestant formula (*"Take and eat this in remembrance that Christ died for thee"*) with traditional Catholic wording (*"The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy body and soul"*), permitting worshippers to interpret the bread and wine according to their own conscience. Church attendance on Sundays was compulsory: those who refused were branded **recusants** and fined **one shilling** per missed service (roughly a week's wages for a skilled labourer).

PRIMARY RECORD ENACTED PARLIAMENTARY STATUTE (1 ELIZ. 1 C. 1) April 1559

Source A: From the 1559 Act of Supremacy

> *"No foreign prince, person, prelate, state or potentate, spiritual or temporal, shall at any time use, enjoy or exercise any manner of power, jurisdiction, superiority, authority, pre-eminence or privilege, spiritual or ecclesiastical, within this realm... And that your Highness, your heirs and successors, shall be the only Supreme Governor of this realm in all spiritual and ecclesiastical things."*

The landmark constitutional statute abolishing papal jurisdiction in England and establishing the Queen as "Supreme Governor" rather than "Supreme Head".

Hinge Question: *What practical theological compromise was achieved by substituting "Supreme Governor" for "Supreme Head", and why was this crucial for securing moderate Catholic acquiescence?*

PRIMARY RECORD CROWN EXECUTIVE ORDERS TO CLERGY July 1559

Source B: From Queen Elizabeth's Royal Injunctions

> *"All monuments of feigned miracles, pilgrimages, idolatry, and superstition shall be utterly taken away and destroyed, so that there remain no memory of the same in walls, glass windows, or elsewhere within their churches... Every parson, vicar, and curate shall provide one book of the whole Bible of the largest volume in English, to be set up in some convenient place within the church."*

Official directives delivered by royal commissioners visiting all 9,000 parish churches to eliminate Catholic superstition while mandating the English Bible.

Hinge Question: *How did the Royal Injunctions balance Protestant demands for vernacular scripture with Elizabeth's desire to maintain liturgical dignity and avoid violent iconoclasm?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 1.2 GLOSSARY

SUPREME GOVERNOR
The compromise title assumed by Elizabeth in the 1559 Act of Supremacy, appeasing Catholics who believed only Christ or the Pope could be Supreme Head of the Church.

ACT OF UNIFORMITY
The 1559 law establishing a single, compulsory form of national worship, enforcing the Book of Common Prayer and imposing a 1-shilling fine on recusants.

RECUSANT
A devout Catholic who refused to attend Church of England Sunday services, choosing to practice the Roman faith in secret and pay recurring financial penalties.

ROYAL INJUNCTIONS
A set of 57 royal administrative instructions issued in 1559, ordering English Bibles in parishes, banning pilgrimages, and mandating preacher licenses.

KT 1.2 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

The 'Settlement' of Religion, 1559 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE ROYAL INJUNCTIONS & MECHANISMS OF PARISH ENFORCEMENT

[3.1] To enforce the settlement at grassroots level, William Cecil issued fifty-seven **Royal Injunctions (1559)**. These detailed administrative orders instructed the clergy on parish operations. The Injunctions struck a careful balance: priests were commanded to preach the Royal Supremacy, denounce the Pope's usurped power, and ensure that every parish church purchased a large copy of the English Bible. To stamp out traditional Catholic superstition, pilgrimages to local holy wells were outlawed, fake relics were destroyed, and candle-burning before images was forbidden.

[3.2] However, Elizabeth inserted vital ceremonial concessions to soothe traditionalist parishioners. Church interiors retained an altar table rather than a plain wooden communion board; church music and organ-playing were encouraged; kneeling during prayer and bowing at the name of Jesus were maintained; and clergymen were permitted to marry only with the formal approval of their bishop and two JPs. Clergy were required to wear traditional liturgical dress: a white linen surplice during services and an outdoor black cope. Preaching was strictly policed: to prevent radical puritan or Catholic rabble-rousing, only ministers licensed by the Crown or a bishop were allowed to deliver sermons; unlicensed clergy were required to read approved homilies.

[3.3] Enforcement was carried out through nationwide episcopal **visitations**. In the summer of 1559, royal commissioners toured every diocese in England, inspecting church buildings, examining clergy qualifications, checking for English Bibles, and administering the Oath of Supremacy. Approximately 400 Marian priests who refused to conform were deprived of their posts, but the overwhelming majority conformed. Visitations were repeated every three to four years, ensuring that parish life steadily conformed to the statutory Elizabethan baseline.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1504–1575



Matthew Parker

ARCHBISHOP OF CANTERBURY (1559–1575)

Appointed Archbishop of Canterbury by Elizabeth in 1559 to implement and defend the 'Middle Way'. A moderate Protestant scholar who had served as Anne Boleyn's chaplain, Parker provided intellectual stability and enforced clerical discipline during the Vestment Controversy.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Consecrated Archbishop in December 1559, supervising the restructuring of the Church of England after the Marian restoration.
- Helped guide the passage of the 1559 Acts of Supremacy and Uniformity, establishing the theological framework of the Church of England.
- Issued the 1566 'Book of Advertisements' enforcing uniform clerical dress, firmly dismissing 37 London Puritan clergy who refused to comply.

SECTION 4 THE CHURCH OF ENGLAND AS AN ENGINE OF STATE AUTHORITY

[4.1] In sixteenth-century England, the Church was far more than a spiritual sanctuary; it was the state's supreme engine for nationwide social control, political indoctrination, and local administration. With no television, radio, or newspapers, the parish pulpit was the Crown's primary communication network. Every Sunday, thousands of congregations assembled to hear royal proclamations read aloud and recite prayers of thanks for the Queen's health and the preservation of the realm. Obedience to the monarch was preached as a direct commandment from God; rebellion was branded as the ultimate mortal sin.

[4.2] The Church operated its own powerful judicial apparatus known as **Church courts (consistory courts)**. These ecclesiastical tribunals held immense jurisdiction over everyday communal life. While common law courts handled felonies, Church courts policed morality—prosecuting slander, drunkenness, and recusancy—while overseeing wills, marriages, and parish schools.

[4.3] Furthermore, the parish church served as the social heartbeat of community life. Churchwardens organized seasonal festivals—such as May Day, harvest suppers, and Easter parish fairs—which reinforced communal solidarity and social cohesion. By preserving the traditional visual splendor of churches, rood screens, and musical liturgy, Elizabeth allowed ordinary peasants to experience the comforting familiarity of their ancestral rituals within a Protestant theological framework.

CORE SPECIFICATION THEME THE VIA MEDIA • 1559

The 1559 Settlement: Strategic Compromise Matrix

Elizabeth's 'Middle Way' was designed to establish national conformity while avoiding religious persecution that could trigger civil war:

PROTESTANT VICTORIES:	CATHOLIC CONCESSIONS:
• English Book of Common Prayer mandatory in all parishes. • Monasteries dissolved; Catholic shrines and pilgrimages banned. • Royal Supremacy restored; papal authority formally abolished. • Clergy permitted to marry with episcopal permission.	• Title changed to 'Supreme Governor' (reassuring Catholic consciences). • Priests wore traditional Catholic vestments (surplice/cope). • Communion wording deliberately ambiguous regarding transubstantiation. • Modest recusancy fine of 1 shilling per missed Sunday service.

Strategic Legacy: The Settlement prioritized political outward obedience over private conscience, successfully securing national order for a decade before foreign papal intervention escalated tensions.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 1.2 SEQUENCE

Feb 1559 • Parliamentary Resistance
Catholic bishops in House of Lords reject initial supremacy bills; Elizabeth prorogues parliament.

Apr 1559 • Settlement Acts Passed
Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity pass Lords by 3 votes; establishes Supreme Governor & Prayer Book.

Summer 1559 • Royal Visitations
Royal commissioners tour 9,000 parishes to enforce Oath of Supremacy; ~400 Marian priests deprived.

Dec 1559 • Parker Consecrated
Anne Boleyn's chaplain Matthew Parker consecrated Archbishop of Canterbury to lead Church.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

Exam Challenge: "The Religious Settlement was successful in resolving religious divisions in England in 1559." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Specification Stimulus: (1) The Act of Supremacy • (2) The Act of Uniformity • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 3 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 1.3

Challenge to the Religious Settlement

Historical Enquiry: To what extent did radical Puritan resistance and domestic Catholic dissent threaten the stability of the Elizabethan regime by 1570?

SECTION 1 THE PURITAN CHALLENGE: CRUCIFIXES, VESTMENTS & LAMBETH RESISTANCE

[1.1] While the 1559 Religious Settlement achieved broad national acceptance, it faced fierce ideological resistance from two unyielding extremes. From within Protestant ranks came the challenge of the **Puritans**—zealous reformers who believed Elizabeth's 'Middle Way' was a cowardly, half-hearted compromise that retained the idolatrous 'dregs of popery'. Puritans adhered to strict Calvinist theology: they believed in double predestination, rejected the authority of bishops, demanded a church governed by elected elders (Presbyterians), and insisted that any practice not explicitly mentioned in the Bible was a sinful invention of the Antichrist.

[1.2] The Puritan challenge erupted in two major flashpoints during the 1560s. The first was the **Crucifix Controversy**. Elizabeth insisted on keeping a silver crucifix and burning candles in her royal chapel, and ordered that every parish church retain a crucifix on the rood screen to comfort Catholic parishioners. Puritan bishops, led by Edmund Grindal and John Jewel, fiercely condemned crucifixes as idolatrous images that violated the Second Commandment. Several bishops threatened to resign en masse. Lacking educated Protestant clergymen to replace them, Elizabeth backed down and removed crucifixes from parish churches, though she stubbornly retained one in her private chapel.

[1.3] The second crisis was the **Vestment Controversy (1565–1566)**. Puritans rejected the mandatory white linen surplice, arguing that special priestly garments suggested ministers possessed supernatural powers to turn bread into Christ's body. By 1565, many London preachers were refusing to wear the surplice, dressing in plain black gowns. Elizabeth ordered Archbishop Matthew Parker to enforce uniform dress. In 1566, Parker issued the *Book of Advertisements* and summoned 110 London ministers to Lambeth Palace for a dress inspection. Thirty-seven ministers boldly refused to conform and were summarily dismissed from their livings. Despite their fury, Puritans remained politically loyal to Elizabeth because the only alternative—a Catholic monarch like Mary Stuart—was unthinkable.

SECTION 2 THE NORTHERN CATHOLIC STRONGHOLD & RECUSANT RESISTANCE

[2.1] The Catholic challenge posed a far graver existential danger. In 1558, a substantial portion of the English population—and perhaps one-third of the nobility—remained devoted to Roman Catholicism. In northern counties such as Yorkshire, Durham, and Lancashire, Catholic influence was entrenched under the protection of ancient feudal families like the Percys (Earls of Northumberland) and the Nevilles (Earls of Westmorland). These magnates maintained private domestic chaplains who celebrated Latin masses in manor house attics, shielded secret priests, and quietly boycotted the local parish church.

[2.2] During the early 1560s, Elizabeth pursued a calculated policy of strategic leniency. She instructed county magistrates and JPs not to enforce recusancy fines with excessive severity, famously remarking that she had "no desire to make windows into men's souls." Elizabeth understood that pushing conservative Catholics into a corner would spark a peasant uprising. Moderate Catholics attended Church of England services to avoid fines and show outward loyalty, while privately practicing traditional devotions at home—a group historians describe as 'church papists'.

[2.3] However, this delicate balance collapsed in the late 1560s. In 1566, Pope Pius V issued an official instruction forbidding English Catholics from attending Church of England services under pain of mortal sin. Simultaneously, the Catholic northern nobility grew intensely alienated: Elizabeth systematically bypassed ancient Catholic peers in favor of Protestant 'new men' like Cecil, while Protestant bishops aggressively cracked down on traditional northern customs. In November 1569, this resentment exploded into the armed **Revolt of the Northern Earls**, proving that domestic Catholicism could easily mobilize into armed rebellion against the Crown.

PRIMARY RECORD PAPAL BULL OF EXCOMMUNICATION 25 February 1570

Source A: Pope Pius V's Papal Bull Regnans in Excelsis

> *"We do out of the fullness of our Apostolic power declare the aforesaid Elizabeth to be a heretic and favourer of heretics... And we declare her to be deprived of her pretended title to the aforesaid crown, and of all lordship, dignity, and privilege. And we also declare all nobles, subjects, and peoples of the said kingdom absolved from any oath of fidelity and obedience to her."*

The papal decree excommunicating Elizabeth and commanding all Catholic subjects to depose her on pain of anathema, directly triggering the 1571 Treasons Act.

Hinge Question: *Why did Pope Pius V's release of this bull inadvertently endanger English Catholics by making religious loyalty appear synonymous with treason against the Crown?*

PRIMARY RECORD CALVINIST CLERICAL PETITION TO PARLIAMENT 1566

Source B: London Puritan Petition Against Clerical Vestments

> *"These popish garments, the surplice and the cope, are the badges of idolatry and the livery of the Antichrist. They were invented by the Church of Rome to deck out superstitious priests at their idolatrous Mass. How can a faithful minister of Jesus Christ clothe himself in the defiled garments of the Pope while preaching the pure Gospel of truth to the flock?"*

Radical Protestant protest against Archbishop Parker's Book of Advertisements, which mandated that all parish clergy wear the white linen surplice.

Hinge Question: *Why was Elizabeth so inflexible on enforcing uniform clerical vestments, even though she was willing to tolerate private theological reservations?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 1.3 GLOSSARY

VESTMENT CONTROVERSY
The 1565–66 dispute where radical Puritan clergy refused to wear Catholic-style surplices and copes, resulting in the sacking of 37 London ministers by Archbishop Parker.

PURITAN
A committed, radical Protestant who believed Elizabeth's 1559 settlement was an incomplete compromise, seeking to completely purify the Church of popish ceremonies and bishops.

COUNTER-REFORMATION
The aggressive global campaign launched by the Catholic Papacy and Council of Trent to stamp out Protestant heresy and reclaim England and Europe for Rome.

PAPAL BULL
An official formal decree with a lead seal issued by the Pope. In 1570, *Regnans in Excelsis* excommunicated Elizabeth and ordered her subjects to rebel.

KT 1.3 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

Challenge to the Religious Settlement (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE COUNTER-REFORMATION & DOUAI'S CLANDESTINE MISSIONARIES

[3.1] The domestic Catholic threat was dramatically amplified by international developments. Across Western Europe, the Catholic Church launched the **Counter-Reformation**—a militant, highly coordinated campaign to stamp out Protestant heresy and reclaim lost territories for Rome. Spearheaded by the **Council of Trent (1545–1563)**, the Catholic hierarchy reformed Church abuses, standardized Latin theology, and established aggressive missionary orders like the Society of Jesus (Jesuits) to lead the spiritual reconquest.

[3.2] A central weapon in this campaign was the training of English Catholic priests in continental Europe. In 1568, an exiled English Catholic scholar, **Cardinal William Allen**, founded a specialized seminary college at Douai in the Spanish Netherlands. The college was established to train English Catholic youths in missionary theology and ordain them as seminary priests. From 1574 onwards, these priests were smuggled into England disguised as merchants, soldiers, and tutors. Sheltered in Catholic manor houses in specialized 'priest holes' built by Nicholas Owen, they traveled from village to village celebrating secret Latin masses, hearing confessions, and stiffening Catholic resistance.

[3.3] For the Elizabethan regime, the seminary priests were not mere religious ministers; they were viewed as hostile enemy agents sent by foreign Catholic superpowers. The Spanish Netherlands, lying directly across the English Channel, was garrisoned by 50,000 veteran Spanish troops under the brutal Duke of Alba, who was crushing the Dutch Protestant revolt. English ministers feared that seminary priests were preparing a domestic Catholic fifth column to assist a Spanish invasion fleet, transforming religious faith into a vital front of European geopolitics.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1504–1572



Pope Pius V

BISHOP OF ROME & SUPREME PONTIFF OF THE ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH (1566–1572)

A fierce inquisitor and leader of the Counter-Reformation who hardened the Catholic Church's stance against Protestant monarchs. In 1570, he issued the fateful Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*, decisively transforming English Catholic dissent into political treason.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Enforced the decrees of the Council of Trent, demanding total Catholic separation from Protestant church services and rituals.
- Issued the Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis* on 25 February 1570, declaring Elizabeth a heretic and excommunicating her from the Church.
- Explicitly absolved English Catholics of their oath of allegiance to the Crown, declaring that obeying Elizabeth was a mortal sin.

SECTION 4 THE THUNDERCLAP: REGNANS IN EXCELSIS & THE TREASON THRESHOLD

[4.1] The ultimate turning point in Elizabethan religious history occurred on 25 February 1570, when Pope Pius V issued the fateful Papal Bull ***Regnans in Excelsis***. This decree was an act of extraordinary spiritual aggression. The Pope officially excommunicated Elizabeth, castigating her as "the pretended Queen of England and the servant of crime." The bull declared Elizabeth a heretic, stripped her of her royal title, and released all English subjects from their oaths of fealty and obedience. Most dangerously, the Pope commanded English Catholics to disobey the Queen's laws under threat of excommunication.

[4.2] *Regnans in Excelsis* placed English Catholics in an impossible, tragic dilemma. Before 1570, a Catholic could remain a loyal subject of Queen Elizabeth while privately practicing their faith. After 1570, the Pope insisted that total loyalty to Rome required active disobedience to the Crown. Conversely, the Elizabethan government could no longer view recusancy as harmless personal eccentricity: anyone who acknowledged the Pope's authority was now, by definition, affirming that Elizabeth was not the lawful queen and that her deposition was a religious duty.

[4.3] Parliament responded decisively to the Papal Bull with the **Treasons Act (1571)**. This harsh statute made it high treason, punishable by hanging, drawing, and quartering, to declare that Elizabeth was not the lawful queen, to possess or publish papal bulls, or to convert anyone to the Roman Catholic faith. Anyone leaving England for more than six months without royal permission had their lands confiscated. The 1570 bull permanently shattered Elizabeth's policy of calculated leniency, forging an unbreakable link between English Protestantism and patriotic national survival.

CRITICAL TURNING POINT PAPAL DIPLOMACY • 1570

The Mutation of Catholic Dissent: Faith to High Treason

Before 1570, Elizabeth tolerated Catholic recusants who quietly paid their 1-shilling fines, famously refusing to "make windows into men's souls." The 1570 Papal Bull shattered this compromise:

- **The Papal Dilemma:** English Catholics were placed in an impossible moral double-bind: obedience to their Queen meant eternal damnation by the Pope, while obedience to the Pope made them traitors liable to horrific execution.
- **The Treasons Act (1571):** Parliament responded swiftly by making it high treason to possess or publish papal bulls, describe Elizabeth as a heretic, or attempt to convert English subjects to Rome.
- **Geopolitical Justification:** Foreign Catholic monarchs (Philip II of Spain and the French Guise faction) now possessed explicit spiritual sanction to assassinate Elizabeth and invade England.

Strategic Legacy: *Regnans in Excelsis* backfired on English Catholics: instead of rallying the populace to rebellion, it unified patriotic English Protestants and forced the Elizabethan state to criminalize Catholic practice.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 1.3 SEQUENCE

July 1560 • Treaty of Edinburgh
French troops withdraw from Scotland; Mary Stuart's claim to the English throne is formally blocked.

Mar 1566 • Parker's Advertisements
Archbishop enforces surplice vestments; 37 London Puritan ministers dismissed for non-compliance.

1568 • Douai Seminary Founded
William Allen establishes English Catholic college in Flanders to train missionary priests.

25 Feb 1570 • Regnans in Excelsis
Pope Pius V excommunicates Elizabeth; absolves subjects of allegiance, making Catholicism treason.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

Exam Challenge: Explain why Puritans challenged the Religious Settlement in the 1560s. [12 marks]

Specification Stimulus: (1) The vestments controversy • (2) The crucifix controversy • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

ENQUIRY 4 1HI0/B4 • KEY TOPIC 1.4

The Problem of Mary, Queen of Scots, 1568–69

Historical Enquiry: Why did the arrival of Mary Stuart in 1568 create an insoluble dynastic crisis and a permanent Catholic figurehead against Elizabeth?

SECTION 1 THE SCOTTISH TRAGEDY: MURDER, SCANDAL & LOCHLEVEN ABDICATION

[1.1] In the late 1560s, a political earthquake in Scotland hurled the greatest dynastic crisis of Elizabeth's reign across the English border. Mary Stuart, Queen of Scots, was Elizabeth's first cousin once removed–the granddaughter of Henry VIII's elder sister Margaret Tudor. Tall, charismatic, and cultured, Mary had been crowned Queen of Scotland at just six days old and raised at the glamorous French court as Dauphine and Queen Consort. Following the premature death of her French husband King Francis II in 1560, eighteen-year-old Mary returned to Edinburgh to rule a turbulent kingdom dominated by fierce, Protestant feudal nobles known as the Lords of the Congregation.

[1.2] Mary's personal rule descended into violent melodrama and scandal. In 1565, she made the catastrophic decision to marry her handsome English Catholic cousin, Henry Stuart, **Lord Darnley**. The marriage quickly collapsed into drunken jealousy and political intrigue. In March 1566, Darnley and a cabal of Protestant lords burst into Mary's private chambers at Holyroodhouse and savagely stabbed her Italian secretary, David Rizzio, fifty-six times before her eyes while she was six months pregnant. Eleven months later, on 10 February 1567, Darnley himself was murdered in Edinburgh: his lodgings at Kirk o'Field were obliterated by gunpowder barrels, and his strangled corpse was discovered in the adjacent garden.

[1.3] Public outrage reached boiling point when, barely three months later, Mary married the chief suspect in Darnley's assassination, James Hepburn, **Earl of Bothwell**. Convinced of Mary's complicity in regicide, Scotland's Protestant lords rose in armed rebellion. They defeated Mary's forces at Carberry Hill in June 1567, imprisoned her on an island fortress at **Lochleven Castle**, and forced her at swordpoint to abdicate the Scottish crown in favour of her thirteen-month-old infant son, King James VI, under a Protestant regency. Bothwell fled into exile, dying insane in a Danish prison. The Scottish Reformation had triumphed: John Knox and the Presbyterian kirk now held ideological sway in Edinburgh, transforming Scotland from England's historic enemy into a fragile Protestant buffer state.

SECTION 2 THE FISHING BOAT AT WORKINGTON & THE DIPLOMATIC TRAP

[2.1] In May 1568, Mary pulled off a daring escape from Lochleven with the help of loyal servants, rallying a small army of six thousand supporters. However, on 13 May 1568, her forces were decisively routed by the Regent Murray's army at the Battle of Langside near Glasgow. Terrified of falling back into the hands of her rebellious nobles, Mary made the fateful decision that would seal her doom: she fled south to the Solway Firth and, on **16 May 1568**, stepped into an open fishing boat and crossed the waters into England, landing at the obscure port of Workington in Cumberland.

[2.2] Mary's arrival in England threw Elizabeth and William Cecil into total panic. Mary arrived expecting hospitality, sisterly royal solidarity, and an English army to restore her to her Scottish throne. Instead, her physical presence in England created an insoluble constitutional crisis. Under Catholic canon law, Mary possessed a stronger, purer claim to the English crown than Elizabeth, whom Catholics regarded as an illegitimate bastard. In England, Mary was an anointed monarch, a legitimate heir presumptive, and a living, magnetic focal point for every disgruntled Catholic noble in the realm.

[2.3] Elizabeth found herself impaled upon the horns of an impossible four-way dilemma. She could not restore Mary to Scotland with English troops without alienating Scotland's friendly Protestant regents and placing a hostile Catholic regime on her northern border. She could not allow Mary to seek refuge in France, where the Catholic Guise family would supply an invasion fleet to conquer England. Nor could she grant Mary freedom to travel within England, where she would immediately become the figurehead for northern Catholic rebellion. Finally, she could not execute an anointed monarch without establishing a terrifying precedent that threatened royal sovereignty everywhere. Elizabeth had Mary arrested and placed in secure custody at Carlisle Castle, beginning nineteen years of honourable English captivity.

PRIMARY RECORD PERSONAL SOVEREIGN CORRESPONDENCE 28 May 1568

Source A: Mary Stuart's Letter to Elizabeth from Carlisle

> *"I entreat you to send for me as soon as possible, for I am in a pitiable condition, not only for a Queen, but for a gentlewoman, having nothing in the world but the clothes on my back in which I escaped... I have fled to you, my nearest kinswoman and fellow sovereign, trusting entirely in your honour and royal promise to aid and restore me to my rightful throne."*

Written by Mary Stuart immediately following her escape across the Solway Firth into Cumberland, seeking English military intervention to regain Scotland.

Hinge Question: *Why did Mary Stuart's status as an anointed, captive monarch make it impossible for Elizabeth to either restore her by armed force or put her on public trial?*

PRIMARY RECORD CONFIDENTIAL PRIVY COUNCIL MEMORANDUM June 1568

Source B: Sir William Cecil's State Paper on Mary Stuart

> *"If she remain in England, she will be a constant firebrand. The papists will flock to her; the disaffected nobility will look to her as their rising sun. While she lives and is present in the realm, Her Majesty cannot be safe from assassination or rebellion, for Mary claims the right to wear the English crown today, not after Her Majesty's death."*

Principal Secretary William Cecil's urgent warning to the Privy Council that Mary's physical presence in England would serve as a permanent magnet for Catholic treason.

Hinge Question: *How accurately did Cecil's prophetic memorandum anticipate the outbreak of the 1569 Revolt of the Northern Earls and subsequent Catholic plots?*

CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY • SPECIFICATION TERMS

KT 1.4 GLOSSARY

HEIR PRESUMPTIVE
The person dynastically entitled to inherit the crown if the reigning monarch dies without direct legitimate offspring (Mary Stuart held this claim from 1558).

CASKET LETTERS
A collection of eight French love letters and sonnets allegedly written by Mary Stuart to Bothwell, presented as evidence of her complicity in Darnley's murder.

CONFERENCE OF YORK
The 1568–69 judicial enquiry convened by Elizabeth to examine the Scottish charges against Mary Stuart, concluding with an ambiguous verdict of "not proven".

ANOINTED MONARCH
A ruler consecrated by holy oil in a church coronation, believed to rule by Divine Right, making their trial, deposition, or execution a grave spiritual sin.

KT 1.4 ENQUIRY STUDY DISCIPLINARY ANALYSIS

The Problem of Mary, Queen of Scots, 1568–69 (Continued)

SECTION 3 THE CONFERENCE OF YORK & THE CASKET LETTERS MYSTERY

[3.1] To establish legal justification for keeping an anointed foreign monarch under house arrest without trial, Elizabeth convened a judicial inquiry. Between October 1568 and January 1569, commissioners met at the **Conference of York** (later moved to Hampton Court and Westminster) to examine charges brought by the Scottish Protestant regents against their queen. The Regent Murray produced a small silver casket containing eight handwritten French letters and love sonnets, allegedly discovered in Bothwell's baggage—the infamous **Casket Letters**. The letters purported to prove that Mary was violently in love with Bothwell and had actively lured Darnley to Kirk o'Field to be blown up.

[3.2] Mary fiercely denied the authenticity of the letters, insisting they were forged by Murray's Protestant faction to justify her illegal deposition. She demanded the right to attend the conference in person to cross-examine her accusers and view the original documents. Elizabeth flatly refused, fearing Mary's regal presence and forensic eloquence would sway the English commissioners. Crucially, the Scottish regents produced only copies, and the original letters subsequently vanished into history, leaving historians to debate their authenticity to this day.

[3.3] In January 1569, Elizabeth delivered a masterclass in political ambiguity, issuing an official verdict that *"nothing has been sufficiently proven"* against either side. Murray's regency in Scotland was left intact, Darnley's murder was left unresolved, and Mary was neither convicted of murder nor exonerated of treason. This calculated stalemate gave Elizabeth the legal pretext she desperately needed: because Mary was not cleared of murdering her husband, Elizabeth could refuse to receive her at court and justify keeping her in indefinite English custody.

KEY HISTORICAL FIGURE 1542–1587



Mary Stuart (Mary, Queen of Scots)

QUEEN OF SCOTLAND (1542–1567) & CATHOLIC CLAIMANT TO THE ENGLISH THRONE

Elizabeth's first cousin once removed, granddaughter of Henry VIII's sister Margaret Tudor, and legitimate Catholic heir presumptive. Her arrival in England in 1568 in an open fishing boat triggered a permanent dynastic and security crisis that plagued Elizabeth for nearly two decades.

DECISIVE ACTIONS:

- Claimed the English crown upon Mary I's death in 1558, quartering the royal arms of England with those of France and Scotland.
- Forced to abdicate the Scottish throne at Lochleven Castle in 1567 following the scandalous murder of Darnley and marriage to Bothwell.
- Escaped to England in May 1568, where she remained in honourable English custody for 19 years until her execution at Fotheringhay in 1587.

SECTION 4 THE GOLDEN CAGE & THE GATHERING STORM OF REBELLION

[4.1] Following the Conference of York, Mary was transferred deep into the English Midlands, placed under the honourable custody of George Talbot, **Earl of Shrewsbury**. Shrewsbury hosted Mary at his fortified estates—Tutbury, Sheffield, and Chatsworth. Mary lived in regal splendour with thirty servants, yet her correspondence was intercepted by Cecil's agents and her visitors monitored with paranoid vigilance.

[4.2] Indefinite captivity transformed Mary from a discredited Scottish fugitive into a tragic Catholic martyr. For the English Catholic aristocracy, Mary represented the glorious hope of a restored Roman Catholic England. Her presence in the Midlands acted as a magnetic catalyst, galvanizing domestic conspirators, Spanish diplomats, and papal agents. Within months of her arrival, conservative English peers hatched a clandestine scheme to marry Mary to Thomas Howard, the Duke of Norfolk—the premier peer of England—to force Elizabeth to name Mary her successor.

[4.3] When Elizabeth discovered the Norfolk marriage plot in the autumn of 1569, Norfolk fled from court, and in November 1569, the Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland raised four thousand armed rebels in the **Revolt of the Northern Earls**. The rebels stormed Durham Cathedral, tore up the English Bible, and celebrated Latin mass before marching south to liberate Mary. Although royal armies crushed the rebellion, Mary Stuart's presence had permanently shattered England's internal peace, plunging the Elizabethan regime into an era of domestic plots, secret intelligence wars, and existential peril.

CONSTITUTIONAL IMPASSE DIPLOMATIC CRISIS • 1568

Elizabeth's Four Fatal Options Regarding Mary Stuart

When Mary landed at Workington in May 1568, Elizabeth faced four equally dangerous constitutional choices:

- **Option A: Restore Mary to Scotland with an English Army:** Would uphold the divine right of anointed monarchs, but would alienate Scotland's Protestant regents and replace friendly allies with a hostile Catholic regime.
- **Option B: Exile Mary to France:** Would remove the immediate problem from England, but would allow Mary to rally French royal forces and organize a Catholic invasion fleet across the Channel.
- **Option C: Grant Mary Free Passage in England:** Would enable her to tour the Catholic northern counties, meeting disgruntled nobility and actively rallying support to depose Elizabeth.
- **Option D: Keep Mary in Indefinite English Captivity:** Avoided foreign war and immediate rebellion, but turned Mary into a permanent living martyr and figurehead for endless domestic plots.

Strategic Legacy: Elizabeth chose Option D. By keeping Mary captive under the Earl of Shrewsbury, she preserved temporary peace while unwittingly constructing the catalyst for nineteen years of continuous assassination plots.

KEY CHRONOLOGY • FOUR CAUSAL TURNING POINTS KT 1.4 SEQUENCE

10 Feb 1567 • Kirk o'Field Murder
Mary's husband Lord Darnley murdered; Mary scandalously marries suspected assassin Bothwell.

24 Jul 1567 • Lochleven Abdication
Scottish Protestant lords force Mary's abdication in favour of infant son King James VI.

16 May 1568 • Flight to Workington
Mary escapes Lochleven, crosses Solway Firth, and lands in Cumberland seeking English sanctuary.

Dec 1568 • Conference of York
Investigation into Casket Letters; Elizabeth delivers 'not proven' verdict to keep Mary captive.

EXAM STRATEGY • EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (OPTION B4) Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

Exam Challenge: "The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the main cause of instability in England in the years 1568–69." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

Specification Stimulus: (1) Mary's claim to the throne • (2) The Catholic nobility • *Construct 3 PEEL paragraphs using precise factual evidence.* GRADE 9 STANDARD

SYNOPTIC OVERVIEW KEY TOPIC 1 MASTER SYNTHESIS • 1558–1569

Key Topic 1: Thematic Synoptic Matrix & Historiographical Debate

Historical Assessment: Evaluating Elizabeth's consolidation of royal authority across government, religious settlement, and dynastic security.

THEMATIC COMPARATIVE MATRIX • CORE SPECIFICATION THEMES — **1558 CRISIS VS. 1569 REALITY**

THEMATIC DIMENSION	THE CRISIS IN 1558	ELIZABETH'S STRATEGIC MECHANISM	THE BALANCE SHEET BY 1569
1. Royal Legitimacy & Gender	Regarded as illegitimate by Catholic Europe; 16th-century misogynistic doctrine declared women unfit for supreme sovereignty (John Knox's *First Blast*).	Adopted compromise title 'Supreme Governor'; weaponized marriage negotiations as diplomatic leverage; projected majestic virgin iconography.	Royal sovereignty secured; rival court factions kept in balance; but dynastic succession left precariously unresolved.
2. Crown Finance & Economy	Exchequer £300,000 in debt; £100,000 owed to Antwerp financiers at punitive 14% interest; severe coinage debasement driving runaway inflation.	Enforced rigorous austerity; sold £120,000 of Crown lands; recalled debased coinage and restored pure silver currency under Thomas Gresham.	Antwerp debts eliminated; Crown credit rating restored; fiscal independence reduced reliance on unpredictable parliamentary subsidies.
3. Religious Settlement	Nation religiously fractured: Catholic conservative North/West versus radical Protestant South-East and returning zealous Marian exiles.	Enacted 1559 'Middle Way': Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity, deliberate theological ambiguity in Book of Common Prayer, nominal 1s recusancy fine.	Broad outward conformity achieved across 9,000 parishes; radical Puritans contained; but Catholic resistance festered beneath the surface.
4. Dynastic & Foreign Threat	Calais lost in 1558; France and Scotland united under the Auld Alliance; French Catholic garrisons stationed directly on northern Scottish frontier.	Signed Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis; dispatched naval and land forces in 1560 to enforce Treaty of Edinburgh; placed Mary Stuart in custody in 1568.	French troops expelled from Scotland permanently; but Mary Stuart's physical presence in England galvanized domestic Catholic conspiracy.
5. Privy Council & Patronage	Inherited cumbersome, faction-ridden Marian Privy Council of 50 members; deep mistrust between ancient nobility and reforming administrators.	Streamlined Council to 19 elite administrators; appointed William Cecil Principal Secretary; carefully counterbalanced Cecil against Robert Dudley.	Created disciplined, loyal executive machinery; used monopolies and wardships strategically to bind ambitious aristocrats to the Crown.
6. Succession & Marriage Trap	No legitimate heir; catastrophic risk of dynastic civil war if Elizabeth died; repeated parliamentary petitions demanding marriage and an heir.	Maintained strict Royal Prerogative over marriage; used foreign Catholic suitors (Philip II, Archduke Charles) as diplomatic pawns without commitment.	Prevented foreign monarchical control of England; but left the Protestant realm in existential danger upon Mary Stuart's 1568 arrival.

THE 1559 RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT COMPARATIVE MATRIX — **CATHOLICISM VS. ELIZABETH'S VIA MEDIA VS. PURITANISM**

DIMENSION	TRADITIONAL ROMAN CATHOLICISM	ELIZABETH'S 'VIA MEDIA' (1559)	RADICAL CALVINIST PURITANISM
1. Head of the Church	The Pope in Rome; supreme apostolic vicar of Christ; divine spiritual authority over all earthly monarchs; papal excommunication feared.	**'Supreme Governor' (1559 Act of Supremacy); oath required of all clergy on pain of deprivation; avoided offensive 'Supreme Head' title.**	Jesus Christ alone; earthly monarchs possess no spiritual headship; advocated presbyterian system of regional elders without bishops.
2. Liturgy & Bible	Traditional Latin Tridentine Mass; Latin Vulgate scripture; prayers for souls in purgatory; priest mediating between God and man.	**English 1559 Book of Common Prayer; Cranmer's liturgy revised to conciliate moderates; Great Bible placed in every parish church.**	Preaching-centered sermon; Geneva Bible with Calvinist marginal commentary; metrical psalm-singing; reject standardized prayer book.
3. Eucharist Doctrine	Transubstantiation; bread and wine literally become Christ's physical body and blood through sacerdotal miracle during holy Mass.	**Deliberately ambiguous compromise fusing 1549 real presence words with 1552 memorialist formula to allow individual interpretation.**	Strictly spiritual memorial; transubstantiation condemned as idolatrous heresy; kneeling at communion rejected as idolatry.
4. Clergy & Dress	Celibate priesthood set apart from laity; ornate silk vestments, chasubles, and copes signifying sacrificial altar dignity.	**Clerical marriage permitted with episcopal approval; white linen surplice required in parish churches (1566 Parker's Advertisements).**	Priesthood of all believers; abolition of episcopacy ('popish rags'); plain black Genevan academic preaching gowns strictly enforced.
5. Church Interiors & Ritual	Stone altars, crucifixes, statues of Mary and saints, burning candles, holy water stoups, censers, stained glass windows.	**Wooden communion table replacing stone altar; rood screens preserved; royal arms displayed; organ polyphonic music allowed.**	Aggressive iconoclasm: whitewashed bare walls; total destruction of statues, crucifixes, organs, and idolatrous church ornaments.
6. Recusancy & Conformity	Papal ban on attending Protestant services on pain of mortal sin; secret Catholic masses celebrated by Marian priests in gentry houses.	**1559 Act of Uniformity mandated weekly attendance; 1 shilling fine for recusancy; initial royal policy of non-persecution ('no windows into men's souls').**	Demanded state prosecute Catholic recusants as traitors; held unauthorized 'prophesyings' (clergy study meetings) to train zealous ministers.

THE HISTORIOGRAPHICAL DEBATE • THREE INTERPRETATIONS OF THE 1559 SETTLEMENT

HISTORICAL SCHOLARSHIP

1. TRADITIONAL WHIG (SIR JOHN NEALE, 1957):
Elizabeth was a theological conservative who sought a moderate Henrician settlement without the Pope. However, she was pushed into a much more radical Protestant settlement by an organized caucus of returned Marian exiles in the Commons known as the *'Puritan Choir'*, making the 1559 Via Media a masterclass in pragmatic royal compromise.

2. REVISIONIST (HAIGH & JONES, 1982):
Dismantled Neale's thesis: real legislative opposition came from Marian Catholic bishops in the Lords, not Puritans in the Commons. Jones proved Elizabeth achieved the settlement she planned from the outset; Haigh demonstrated it was an enforced political armistice that alienated devout believers on both wings, merely delaying sectarian rebellion until 1569.

3. POST-REVISIONIST (COLLINSON & DORAN, 1994):
The Elizabethan polity functioned as an early modern 'Monarchical Republic'. Key ministers like William Cecil viewed the 1559 settlement not as an end in itself, but as the constitutional frontline of national security. Protestant magistrates saw themselves as duty-bound guardians of the Reformation against existential Catholic dynastic conspiracies.

Hinge Question for Class Discussion: *Did Elizabeth's religious settlement succeed because of its deliberate theological ambiguity, or did that very ambiguity sow the seeds for the Catholic rebellions of 1569–1570?*

COMPARATIVE POLICY SUCCESS EVALUATION • 1558–1569 — **CRITERIA-LED VERDICT**

1. FISCAL SOLVENCY: HIGH
Crown debt reduced from £300,000 to zero by 1574; £100,000 Antwerp loan cleared; Crown land sales and re-coinage restored financial independence without sparking tax revolts.

2. RELIGIOUS PEACE: MODERATE
Averted immediate religious civil war; outward conformity secured across 9,000 parishes; but failed to reconcile zealous Puritans or conservative Catholic recusants.

3. BORDER DEFENCE: MODERATE
Treaty of Edinburgh expelled French troops from Scotland; averted war with Spain for a decade; but Netherlands crisis began escalating dangerously by 1568.

4. DYNASTIC SUCCESSION: LOW
Refusal to marry or designate an heir left the realm vulnerable; Mary Stuart's 1568 arrival instantly catalyzed armed aristocratic rebellion in 1569.

SYNOPTIC VERDICT • THE DYNAMICS OF EARLY ELIZABETHAN SURVIVAL

Between 1558 and 1569, Elizabeth transformed an impoverished, internally divided realm into a remarkably resilient sovereign state. Her greatest domestic achievements were financial discipline and theological ambiguity: by slashing Crown expenditures, retiring debased coinage, and creating an inclusive religious 'Via Media', she deprived foreign Catholic powers of an immediate pretext for holy war while preserving royal solvency without punitive parliamentary taxation. However, her deliberate refusal to marry or designate an heir left the realm hostage to fortune. The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in 1568 shattered this fragile equilibrium, instantly transforming latent Catholic sympathies into armed domestic rebellion and exposing the inherent vulnerability of Elizabeth's unresolved succession.

EXAM MASTERCLASS EDEXCEL PAPER 2 OPTION B4 • 1HI0/B4

Edexcel Paper 2: Examination Strategy & Exemplar Model Answers

Official Exam Blueprint: Deconstructing Question 1(a) & 1(b) Features [4m], Question 2 Causation [12m], and Question 3 Evaluative Essay [16m + 4 SPaG].

KEY CHRONOLOGY: EIGHT CAUSAL TURNING POINTS (1558–1570)

SPECIFICATION EVIDENCE RECALL

17 Nov 1558 • Accession
Mary dies; 25-yr-old Elizabeth succeeds; appoints William Cecil Principal Secretary at Hatfield.

15 Jan 1559 • Coronation
Westminster ceremony balances traditional Latin ritual with English Gospel reading.

29 Apr 1559 • Settlement Acts
Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity establish Church of England, Prayer Book & 1s recusancy fine.

6 Jul 1560 • Treaty of Edinburgh
French garrisons evacuate Scotland; northern frontier secured under Protestant Lords of Congregation.

1566 • Dutch Revolt Begins
Protestant rebellion against Spanish rule in the Netherlands sparks decades of European religious conflict.

26 Mar 1566 • Advertisements
Archbishop Parker enforces surplice conformity; 37 London Puritan ministers dismissed for non-compliance.

16 May 1568 • Mary at Workington
Mary escapes Lochleven; lands in Cumberland seeking English refuge, unleashing 19-year dynastic crisis.

25 Feb 1570 • Regnans in Excelsis
Pius V excommunicates Elizabeth; absolves Catholic subjects from loyalty, defining Catholicism as treason.

QUESTION 1(A) & 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE OF... [2 MARKS EACH • 4 MARKS TOTAL • 6 MINS]

Formula: 1 Mark Valid Feature + 1 Mark Supporting Detail (0 Explanation/Consequences)

Q1(a): Describe one feature of the 1559 Act of Supremacy. [2 marks]

Model Answer: One feature was Elizabeth's assumption of the title **'Supreme Governor'** of the Church of England rather than 'Supreme Head'. *[1 mark for valid feature]* This was a deliberate political compromise designed to pacify Catholics who believed only the Pope could head Christ's Church, while reassuring Protestants who objected to a female monarch claiming spiritual headship over holy scripture. *[1 mark for supporting historical detail]*

Q1(b): Describe one feature of Church of England visitations in 1559. [2 marks]

Model Answer: One feature was that royal commissioners conducted comprehensive parish inspections to enforce the **Royal Injunctions** and administer the mandatory Oath of Supremacy. *[1 mark for valid feature]* While approximately 400 Marian Catholic priests refused the oath and were deprived of their livings, roughly 9,000 parish clergy swore allegiance, ensuring nationwide religious conformity and institutional stability. *[1 mark for supporting historical detail]*

Examiner Warning: Candidates frequently lose time writing detailed explanations or consequences. For 2-mark feature questions, state the feature directly and add one precise factual statistic, date, or name. Do not explain why it happened!

QUESTION 2: EXPLAIN WHY... [12 MARKS • 18 MINUTES]

Formula: 3 Full PEEL Paragraphs (2 Stimulus + 1 Own Knowledge) + Explicit Causal Connectives

Exam Prompt: Explain why the arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 caused serious problems for Elizabeth I. You may use: (1) Dynastic claims to the throne, (2) The Catholic northern nobility. [12 marks]

PEEL Paragraph 1 (Dynastic Legitimacy & Alternative Monarch): One major reason Mary Stuart's arrival created an immediate existential crisis was her direct and indisputable dynastic claim to the English crown as Henry VII's eldest great-granddaughter. Devout Catholic opinion throughout England and Europe regarded Elizabeth as illegitimate, maintaining that Henry VIII's marriage to Anne Boleyn had never been lawful in the eyes of the Church. *Consequently,* Mary was seen by foreign Catholic princes and domestic conservatives alike as the rightful de jure Queen of England. Her physical presence in Cumberland instantly converted abstract theoretical succession disputes into an imminent mortal danger: Mary became a living, anointed monarch around whom alienated English Catholics could coalesce to depose Elizabeth through foreign-backed invasion or assassination.

PEEL Paragraph 2 (Domestic Feudal Discontent & Northern Earls): Furthermore, Mary's arrival directly ignited acute domestic feudal discontent among the conservative Catholic aristocracy of northern England. Ancient magnates such as Thomas Percy, Earl of Northumberland, and Charles Neville, Earl of Westmorland, were already intensely disaffected by Elizabeth's centralizing Protestant regime, which had stripped them of their ancestral border wardenships and lucrative regional patronage in favour of loyal Protestant southerners like William Cecil and Lord Hunsdon. *As a direct result,* Mary's unexpected arrival provided these desperate, heavily indebted northern nobles with a charismatic Catholic alternative and a catalyst for armed action, culminating in the armed 1569 Revolt of the Northern Earls and the celebration of the traditional Latin Mass in Durham Cathedral.

PEEL Paragraph 3 (Own Knowledge: Foreign Encirclement & The Diplomatic Trap): Crucially, Mary's presence trapped Elizabeth in an intractable international diplomatic dilemma that threatened England with foreign invasion. Mary possessed intimate dynastic alliances with the powerful French Catholic Guise faction through her mother, while King Philip II of Spain saw her as a potential instrument to restore Catholicism across the British Isles. Elizabeth faced an impossible strategic triangle: she could not restore Mary to the Scottish throne with English military force without alienating the Protestant Scottish regents who secured England's northern frontier, nor could she execute an anointed sovereign cousin without uniting Catholic Europe in a holy crusade against England. *Therefore,* indefinite detention in northern castles was an unstable holding measure that permanently invited foreign invasion and papal conspiracy.

Examiner Causation Strategy (Level 4): Contrast Mary Stuart's dynastic claim (underlying threat) with the acute regional grievances of the Northern Earls (immediate trigger). Candidates must explicitly link causes together. **12/12 CRITERIA**

QUESTION 3: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS + 4 SPAG • 25 MINUTES]

Level 4 Standard: 3 Balanced Factors + Criteria-Led Sustained Judgement

Exam Prompt: "The threat of foreign invasion was the most serious problem facing Elizabeth I between 1558 and 1569." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. You may use: (1) The loss of Calais (1558), (2) The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots (1568). [16 marks + 4 SPaG]

FACTOR 1: FOREIGN INVASION (AGREE)
Loss of Calais in January 1558 stripped England of its final continental bridgehead, leaving the southern coast vulnerable; simultaneously, the 1559 Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis ended 65 years of Franco-Spanish war, raising the acute danger that a united Catholic Europe would mount a cross-Channel invasion against the young Protestant Queen.

FACTOR 2: CROWN DEBT & FINANCE (COUNTER)
Inherited Crown debt of £300,000, with £100,000 owed to Antwerp financiers at crushing 14% interest, meant the Crown could not afford a permanent standing army, modern artillery, or coastal fortifications without imposing crippling taxes that would incite immediate domestic rebellion.

FACTOR 3: DYNASTIC LEGITIMACY & MARY (COUNTER)
Mary Stuart's arrival in 1568 provided a living Catholic figurehead who quartered the English royal arms, instantly mobilizing alienated northern feudal magnates and triggering the 1569 Northern Revolt, exposing the fatal domestic vulnerability of Elizabeth's unresolved succession.

EXEMPLAR LEVEL 4 CONCLUSION (CRITERIA-LED SUSTAINED JUDGEMENT):

"In conclusion, while the threat of foreign invasion was undoubtedly the most catastrophic potential danger facing England, financial weakness and royal insolvency represented Elizabeth's most serious foundational problem between 1558 and 1569. When evaluating historical significance using the criterion of foundational constraint, economic solvency was the absolute prerequisite for resolving all other existential challenges: without royal revenue and credit, Elizabeth could neither mobilize military forces to deter foreign invaders nor secure domestic border defenses. Crown debt governed every diplomatic, marital, and fiscal calculation of her first decade. Furthermore, while the foreign threat was successfully contained by 1560 through the Treaty of Edinburgh and the subsequent outbreak of the French Wars of Religion, Mary Stuart's arrival in 1568 transformed the crisis from a distant external hazard into an active internal conspiracy. Therefore, while foreign invasion presented the greatest external peril, fiscal bankruptcy was the root weakness that made England profoundly vulnerable to both foreign aggression and domestic revolt."

SPaG Masterclass (+4 Marks): Spell technical terms accurately (*recusancy, sovereignty, prerogative, Marian exiles*). Use complex analytical sentences with causal connectives. **4/4 SPaG TARGET**

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAMINER MARKING BLUEPRINT & BAND DESCRIPTORS

50 MINS: Q1 6m • Q2 18m • Q3 25m • REV 1m

LEVEL 4 (13–16 MARKS)
Criteria-Led Evaluation: Analytical throughout; deploys line-by-line precise factual evidence; sustained judgement weighing root vs catalytic causes.

LEVEL 3 (9–12 MARKS)
Explanatory & Balanced: Explains both stimulus points plus own knowledge; links factors to prompt, but conclusion summarizes rather than synthesizes.

LEVEL 2 (5–8 MARKS)
Descriptive Narrative: Recounts narrative events without explicit analytical focus; unbalanced or lacks independent own knowledge beyond stimulus.

LEVEL 1 (1–4 MARKS)
Basic Statements: Generalized historical assertions with significant inaccuracies; offers simple assertions without supporting factual detail.

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL SEQUENCE • TURNING POINTS (1558–1570)

CAUSAL PROGRESSION

DATE	PIVOTAL EVENT	HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & CAUSAL CONSEQUENCE
17 Nov 1558	Accession of Elizabeth I	Mary I dies; 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds; inherits £300,000 Crown debt and French war.
Nov 1558	Appointment of William Cecil	Cecil named Principal Secretary, initiating a 40-year partnership of fiscal caution and intelligence.
15 Jan 1559	Westminster Coronation	Elizabeth crowned in Westminster Abbey; balances Latin Catholic ritual with English scripture.
2 Apr 1559	Treaty of Cateau-Cambrésis	Peace between France and Spain; England formally surrenders Calais after two centuries of rule.
29 Apr 1559	Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity	Elizabeth assumes title 'Supreme Governor'; English Prayer Book made compulsory; 1s recusancy fine.
Summer 1559	Royal Injunctions & Visitations	57 injunctions enforce Protestant practice; royal commissioners deprive ~400 non-conforming clergy.
6 Jul 1560	Treaty of Edinburgh	French troops withdraw from Scotland; northern border stabilized under Scottish Protestant lords.
1566	Dutch Revolt Begins	Calvinist riots in Netherlands prompt Philip II to send the Duke of Alba's army, raising English invasion fears.
26 Mar 1566	Book of Advertisements	Archbishop Parker enforces clerical dress; 37 London Puritan ministers dismissed at Lambeth Palace.
1567	Duke of Alba Arrives in Netherlands	Philip II dispatches 50,000 Spanish veterans to crush Dutch revolt, creating invasion threat across Channel.
1568	Douai Seminary Founded	Cardinal William Allen establishes Douai College in Flanders to train missionary priests for England.
16 May 1568	Mary Stuart Lands at Workington	Mary flees Scotland in an open fishing boat; placed in honourable English custody for 19 years.
Oct 1568–Jan 1569	Conference of York	Inquiry into Darnley's murder and Casket Letters concludes 'not proven', justifying Mary's captivity.
25 Feb 1570	Papal Bull Regnans in Excelsis	Pope Pius V excommunicates Elizabeth; frees subjects from loyalty; turns Catholicism into treason.

KEY DISCIPLINARY TERMINOLOGY

- **Great Chain of Being:** Rigid 16th-century divine hierarchy placing the monarch at the apex of all social ranks down to labourers.
- **Royal Prerogative:** Sovereign powers exclusively reserved for the Crown, including marriage, succession, religion, and foreign policy.
- **Supreme Governor:** Elizabeth's title under the 1559 Act of Supremacy, pacifying Catholic consciences while asserting Crown supremacy.
- **Recusant:** A devout Catholic who refused to attend Church of England Sunday services, paying the statutory 1-shilling fine.
- **Royal Injunctions:** 57 administrative directives in 1559 ordering English Bibles, licensing preachers, and banning pilgrimages.
- **Vestment Controversy:** 1565–66 Puritan clash over Catholic-style surplices, resulting in 37 London ministers being sacked.
- **Douai Seminary:** Training college founded in Flanders (1568) by William Allen to prepare Catholic missionary priests to enter England.
- **Papal Bull (1570):** *Regnans in Excelsis* issued by Pope Pius V excommunicating Elizabeth and ordering subjects to depose her.

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 EXAM FRAMEWORK & MODELS

32 MARKS TOTAL • 50 MINS

Q1(a) & Q1(b): Describe ONE feature of... [2 + 2 = 4 Marks • 6 Mins]
Model: "Describe one feature of the 1559 Act of Supremacy."
Formula: 1 mark valid feature + 1 mark supporting historical detail (0 explanation).

Q2: Explain why... [12 Marks • 18 Mins]
Model: "Explain why the arrival of Mary Stuart caused problems for Elizabeth in 1568."
Formula: 3 PEEL paragraphs (2 stimulus + 1 own knowledge) linked with causal connectives.

Q3: Evaluative Essay [16 Marks + 4 SPaG • 25 Mins]
Model: "'The threat of foreign invasion was the main problem facing Elizabeth in 1558.' How far do you agree?"
Formula: 3 balanced analytical paragraphs + criteria-led sustained conclusion.

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVE 1 (AO1 • 50%):
Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the key features and characteristics of the period studied, including precise dates, statistics, and statutory legislation.

ASSESSMENT OBJECTIVE 2 (AO2 • 50%):
Explain and analyse historical events and periods studied using second-order concepts (cause, consequence, change, continuity, and reaching sustained historical judgements).

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL RETRIEVAL HUB **KEY TOPIC 1 KNOWLEDGE QUIZ & FLASHCARDS**

Scan the QR code with any smartphone or tablet camera to launch the interactive, self-marking retrieval bank for Key Topic 1. Test your rapid recall across the Accession Crisis, 1559 Settlement, Vestment Controversy, Douai Seminaries, and Mary Stuart with instant model answers and scoring.

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